

TIRRA Executive Special Meeting

Wednesday, August 17, 2022, 3:00PM

President Wendy Hinsperger called the meeting to order at 3:00PM with the following also present:

- Treasurer and Solid Waste Chairperson, Ernie Hunter
- Secretary, Lisa Vernon
- Trails Chairperson, Vicki Walker
- St. Margaret's Cemetery Chairperson, Suzanne Sarioglu
- Transportation Chairperson, Stu Downey
- Espokes Chairperson, Claire Hess

Absent – Vice President, Quentin Goodbody

Wendy thanked everyone for attending this Special Meeting called by Suzanne and Stu to address:

- voting process at the July 23, 2022 General Members Meeting, relating to operation of the Solid Waste Yard and
- respond to letter from Vicki Walker which she sent to each of the Board Members.

The members then were asked by the President to comment on desired outcomes.

Suzanne moved that a copy of the email of July 30, 2022 sent to the TIRRA president from TIRRA executive members Stu Downey and Suzanne Sarioglu be included in the minutes of the TIRRA executive special meeting of August 17 2022. Stu seconded. All in favour.

Discussion ensued regarding a letter received from Ann Eriksson, as to whether it could be added to the agenda. As it was not part of the Special Meeting agenda proposed, adherence to Roberts Rules requires it to be considered at another time, via an additional call for a TIRRA Executive Special Meeting by two members of the board.

Stu read from a document, which he called a preamble. Vicki moved that Stu's preamble be included in today's minutes. Suzanne seconded. All in favour.

Stu motioned that the first order of business should be to address concerns raised regarding the "voting irregularities" that unfolded at the July 23, 2022 TIRRA GM as first item for Special Meeting agenda. Suzanne seconded. All in favor.

Discussion of TIRRA's Bylaws for the voting process. It was brought to the attention of the board, that the BC Societies Act (which takes priority over TIRRA bylaws), that written notice to all eligible voters is required. Eligible voters in this case includes paid TIRRA members and Thetis Island Property owners (when the vote involves parcel tax implications). Some discussion about preference for written ballots on sensitive issues.

Reference was made to the April 28, 2022 AGM, when the following motion was made:

Veronica Shelford motioned we proceed as soon as can be done with Scenario 1 while pursuing Scenario 2, Ann seconded it, 2 opposed, approved by majority, carried. Description of Scenario 1 and 2 are found at the following associated links.

[2022-04-30 SWM Summary Review to Members.pdf \(thetisland.net\)](#)

[2022-04-30 AGM SWM Presentation April28-converted.pdf \(thetisland.net\)](#)

Discussion regarding immediate opening of the Recycle yard ensued including timing and not needing another motion, as per the above approved motion. Solid Waste Committee (Ernie Hunter: Chairperson and Wendy Hinsperger: Ex Officio Chairperson), responded they had proceeded with investigation of options for recycle hauling and associated costs (CVRD, Recycle BC, GFL), which were required in order to determine budgets for 2023. CVRD requires initial 2023 budget by August 2022, (confirmation will be required later, this is just a preliminary budget request by CVRD). Vicki requested that Ernie get a letter from the CVRD outlining their non-participation in the Thetis Island Recycle Yard. Ernie indicated since we did not have a written agreement with CVRD, it would be difficult to obtain such a letter. No motion or decision.

Suzanne moved that TIRRA opens the recycle yard August 20, 2022, based on April 28 motion approved by members. Vicki seconded. Motion failed.

Suzanne amended the above motion to the date of September 7, 2022. Vicki seconded. 3 in favor, 3 against, 1 abstain. Motion failed.

Suzanne motioned that the secretary of TIRRA, Lisa, coordinate a collective response from TIRRA executive to TIRRA member Vicki Walker's letter dated July 27, 2022. Stu seconded, All in Favor.

Stu moved to annul all solid waste & recycling votes taken at the July 23, 2022 TIRRA GM, accept responsibility and apologize to the community. Schedule a TIRRA Special Resolution secret ballot meeting and vote as soon as possible following all TIRRA bylaws, and BC Societies Act. Suzanne seconded. All in favour

Wendy adjourned the meeting at 5:57 PM.

Included with these minutes as part of full record of proceedings.

Letter from Vicki Walker

Email from Stu Downey and Suzanne Sarioglu requesting Executive Special Meeting

Stu Downey's "preamble"

Suzanne and I want to thank everyone for coming out to the special meeting. Apologies for having to change the meeting date from two weeks ago, Covid is still going strong in our communities.

My personal apologies for missing the 23rd July GM and vote. Even though I wasn't there, I have heard a number of concerns raised. Everyone is watching how TIRRA is going to resolve re-opening the recycling at the solid waste yard, and of course the voting irregularities that occurred on the 23rd. It does concern me when words like circus, and s***show are used to describe the meeting. I see it as an embarrassment to the entire TIRRA Executive.

We represent the community, Residents and Ratepayers. We all bring ourselves to the table, with our own knowledge, experience, skillsets and ideas. The Solid Waste committee is lead by the Solid Waste Chair, same for the other committees; eSpokes, Trails, Cemetery & Transportation.

Over 3 months ago, at the 28th April 2022 TIRRA AGM, a motion was approved for re-opening the recycle yard. A second vote, held at the 23rd July GM, appears to have duplicated the 28Apr but again approving the recycle yard to re-open. Claire cannot simply stop eSpokes going out, even though she is Chair, Suzanne can't decide who gets into the cemetery and who doesn't, Vicki can't start charging tolls for using the Trails, and I can't simply shut down the roads. But after a vote, over 3 months ago, the recycle yard remains closed.

The reasons for requesting this meeting are not against anyone, they are not personal, but are raised in response to community feedback received. This special meeting of the TIRRA Executive was requested to;

- a) collectively respond as an executive to the letter received from Vicki Walker.
- b) address concerns raised regarding the voting irregularities that unfolded at the 23rd July 2022 TIRRA GM.

We are responsible to the community we represent, to be transparent, and to makes things right when we are wrong.

30 July 2022

Wendy Hinsperger
TIRRA President

Hi Wendy,

I have received a hardcopy of Vicki's handwritten letter dated 27th July 2022 addressed to TIRRA Board Members. The letter raises multiple concerns regarding the 23rd July 2022 TIRRA GM.

Additionally, there have been concerns raised regarding the same meeting, from myself, as well as Executive Member Suzanne Sarioglu.

You mention that you yourself will be replying to Vicki's letter Wendy, and add that it is up to each executive member to take their own action if desired.

I see Vicki's letter as being sent to the TIRRA Board Members as a group versus individually, and therefore respectively warrants an executive board response.

TIRRA Bylaws state the following;

6. A special meeting of the Executive Committee shall be held at the request of any two members of the Executive Committee.

Suzanne and I have had a discussion regarding the above concerns, and are requesting a special meeting of the TIRRA Executive be held to

a) collectively respond as an executive to Vicki's letter.

b) address concerns raised in this email regarding the voting irregularities that unfolded at the 28th July 2022 TIRRA GM.

Respectfully,

Stu Downey
Suzanne Sarioglu

July 27, 2022

To: TIRRA Board Members

I have concerns and questions regarding the July 23, 2022 TIRRA General Meeting.

1. The voting process:

- According to the TIRRA by-laws and/or Robert's Rules how many times can you vote on a motion (without amendments)?
- Is it acceptable and permissible to physically segregate the nays and yeas within a voting protocol (again TIRRA by-laws, Robert's Rules)?
- Can a 'straw' vote be upheld against a referendum vote be binding?

2. What is TIRRA's vision for the Solid Waste infrastructure on Thetis Island?

- Charging a fee for recycling is a punitive measure and contrary to what the general public has been taught that recycling is part of their individual contribution/responsibility towards mitigating Climate Change; a collective measure.
- Over decades of studies it has proven that punitive measures are ineffective in changing behavior(s).
- Charging an extra fee for recycling (in situ) falls only within a fiscal field and it discourages full participation by community members.
- Thankfully we have a health care system that does not charge, individually, for joint replacement, heart surgery, or any surgery.

3. What are TIRRA's set of values from which policy, procedure and action is developed?

- Contemporary organizations hold (and proceed from) a set of values, that, like a compass, encompass four areas -

- fiscal (financial)
- environmental
- social/emotional
- equity (access to all, regenerative aspects that cycle back to ~~the~~ benefit the community - employment, composting)

- A recycling fee is fiscal; what of the other three? Financial matters in and of themselves in exclusion, represent a capitalist strategy, not a philosophy per se.

- Point of confusion? Over the past two years TIRRA has paid an employee for eight hours a week to manage garbage in-take and a clearly diminished use of the yard (garbage traffic is minimal). If we're concerned about fiscal responsibility why were these hours of operation not altered?

4. Does TIRRA, as a body of local governance on a parcel tax designation, have a plan on how collectively as a concerned community we can help mitigate climate change?

- What are the other Gulf Island's plans in this regard?

Thank you for your time.

Sincerely, Vicki Walker